

Project Strategy: Gig.Ik (Comprehensive Concept)

1. Core Issues & Real-World Challenges

These are the gaps that the judging board will look for. Your team must have an answer for each.

- **The "WhatsApp Leak" (Disintermediation):** Once a user gets a worker's phone number, they will save it and bypass the app for all future jobs. The app loses its value and its data.
 - **The Trust & Liability Gap:** "Verified" is a dangerous word. If a verified worker performs a poor job, overcharges, or commits a crime, the platform's reputation (and legal standing) is at risk.
 - **The "Ghosting" Problem:** Reliability is low in the manual labor market. Workers often say they are coming but get a better-paying job elsewhere and simply don't show up.
 - **Low Usage Frequency:** People don't hire masons every day. Users are likely to delete the app once the repair is finished to save phone space.
 - **The Tech Literacy Gap:** Many of the best-skilled workers in Sri Lanka are not tech-savvy. They may struggle to manage a profile or respond to app notifications.
 - **The Pricing War:** No fixed rates exist for "leaking pipes." Aggressive haggling on-site leads to bad reviews and unhappy workers.
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2. Practical Solutions (The "Winning" Pivot)

- **Digital Service Log (The "Hook"):** The app keeps a "Home Health Record." Every time a repair is done, the worker uploads a photo. This gives the homeowner a verified history of their house maintenance—useful for resale or insurance. This makes the app a **utility**, not just a directory.
- **The "Double-Confirm" System:** 30 minutes before a job, the app pings the worker. If they don't confirm "I am on my way," the job is immediately offered to the next closest "Gold" worker to ensure the customer isn't left waiting.
- **Tiered Verification Model:**
 - **Bronze:** Phone number & NIC (ID) verified.
 - **Silver:** Background check + 5 high-rated jobs.
 - **Gold:** Recommended by a "Community Leader" or a past employer.
- **Standardized "Visit Fees":** Every job has a mandatory, non-negotiable "Inspection Fee" (e.g., 500 LKR). This protects the worker's travel time and sets a clear starting point for the customer.

- **The "Proxy" Profile:** Allow workers' family members or local "Gig-Agents" to manage the digital side of their business so the worker can focus on the manual labor.
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3. Revenue Model (Who Pays & When)

Instead of a complex subscription, we use the "**Credit Top-Up**" system:

- **Pay-per-Lead:** It is free for workers to be listed. However, they buy "Job Credits" (like a phone reload). It costs 1 credit (e.g., 50 LKR) to unlock a customer's WhatsApp contact.
 - **Daily Visibility Boost:** Workers can pay a small fee to be "Featured" at the top of their local area for 24 hours.
 - **Verification Fee:** A one-time small fee for the "Silver" or "Gold" verification process to cover the cost of background checks.
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4. Target Audience & Competitors

- **Target User:** Urban homeowners or apartment residents (e.g., "Anusha, a busy bank manager") who value **time and safety** over finding the cheapest price.
- **Target Worker:** Skilled freelancers (Electricians, Plumbers, AC Techs) who are currently losing jobs because they don't know how to market themselves.
- **Main Competitors:** * **Informal Networks:** (Neighbors/Family) – *Our Edge:* We are faster (10 mins vs. 2 days).
 - **Facebook Groups:** *Our Edge:* We have verified ratings; Facebook has none.
 - **Classifieds (Ikman):** *Our Edge:* We are a live, location-based service tool, not just an ad board.